

ANNEX A • INTERNAL — SENSITIVE

Pre-Departure Security, Access & Logistical Planning

Preliminary information for a proposed Child Safeguarding investigation visit — SOS Children's Villages Palestine, West Bank area of operation.

Classification	Internal — Sensitive. Distribute on a need-to-know basis.
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1. Purpose and limitations

This annex provides preliminary planning information in response to the questions submitted by the Child Safeguarding investigator about a possible field visit to SOS Children's Villages Palestine in the West Bank. It covers travel and entry, program locations and risks, the security picture, our internal preparation and approval process, access, incident history, medical and emergency arrangements, communications, in-country support, accommodation and movement, contingency and evacuation, safeguarding, and the mandatory SOS Global Travel Safety steps.

Important — preliminary only

Nothing in this annex authorizes entry into the West Bank, access to any program, facility or residential location, contact with any child, young person, family, caregiver or staff member, or any interview, document review or recording. All arrangements remain subject to National Director and management approval, Child Safeguarding clearance, confirmation of the investigation mandate and Terms of Reference, completion of the SOS Global Travel Safety requirements, confirmation of the travellers' entry eligibility, and visit- and location-specific security and safeguarding assessments. Security conditions, crossings, checkpoints and closures can change with little or no notice, so every item here must be revalidated before departure, on arrival, and before each field movement.

2. Responses to the investigator's questions

2.1 Travel and entry

Three routes are possible. The right one depends on each traveler's nationality, passport, residency, travel history and entry eligibility, and on the live status of the

airport or crossing. We will recommend a route only after reviewing the team's details (Section 4).

Route	Best suited when	Key considerations
A. Jordan via King Hussein / Allenby Bridge (Amman → Jericho → Bethlehem)	Most direct for Bethlehem and Hebron; preferred where Ben Gurion is uncertain or the traveler's profile favors Jordan.	Limited hours, possible queues and short-notice closures; separate transport on each side; arrive well before closing. Not available to Israeli-passport holders.
B. Jordan via Jordan River / Sheikh Hussein Bridge (northern)	Contingency if Allenby is closed or unsuitable for a traveler.	Longer onward drive through northern Israel; confirm whether vehicles may cross; treat as a backup route.
C. Ben Gurion Airport (Tel Aviv)	Shortest ground journey to Bethlehem.	Immigration and security questioning, luggage and device checks, possible refusal of entry; the outcome depends on the traveler's profile. Carry full supporting documentation.

Confirm current crossing and airport hours through official sources 72 hours and again 24 hours before travel; do not rely on previously published hours. SOS Palestine cannot guarantee entry on the basis of an invitation letter alone.

2.2 Program locations and preliminary risk profiles

The final in-scope list is confirmed by the National Director, the Child Safeguarding function and program management. SOS Palestine's West Bank programs are in the Bethlehem and Hebron districts, with care and activities connected to Gaza also relevant. The likely locations and headline considerations:

Location	Likely access	Key risks / handling
SOS Children's Village, Bethlehem (alternative care; may include children connected to the Gaza response — to be confirmed)	Feasible, subject to National Director and program approval, safeguarding clearance, an agreed schedule and consent.	Checkpoint and road-gate closures, military operations, movement and ambulance delays, and visitor, safeguarding, and confidentiality risks.
Youth and supported-living homes	Highly sensitive — residential. By approval only; no unannounced visits.	Exact addresses and security arrangements are shared only via a secure channel, on a strict need-to-know basis, after approval of the scope and safeguarding.

Location	Likely access	Key risks / handling
Family Strengthening Program, Bethlehem & Hebron	Office or neutral-location meetings are feasible; household visits are only permitted where necessary and approved.	Rural-area restrictions, settler violence on some roads, family identification or stigma, limited emergency access. Protect identity and dignity.
Hebron locations (including H2 and the southern hills)	Case-by-case, only after a location-specific assessment.	H2 access restrictions, permanent and temporary checkpoints, settler activity, sudden closures. No visit without justification, approvals, a confirmed route and alternate, and a check-in plan.
Gaza	Cannot be confirmed at present; remote interviews may be possible.	Active hostilities, unexploded ordnance, damaged infrastructure, limited medical and communications, no guaranteed evacuation. Any visit needs exceptional, separate authorization.
National Office, Bethlehem	Suitable for management and staff interviews, document review and briefings.	Visitor control, confidentiality, and data protection procedures apply.

2.3 Security briefing and situational assessment

SOS Palestine monitors the environment through internal reporting and external security and humanitarian sources. A visit-specific briefing will be delivered before field activities and will cover current conditions in Bethlehem and Hebron; checkpoints and closures; settler violence and road-specific concerns; regional escalation; medical and emergency procedures; communications and check-ins; areas to avoid; and the movement-suspension, shelter-in-place, relocation, and evacuation steps. The West Bank has a high and changing number of movement obstacles; general regional information never confirms that a specific route is safe, so accessibility is checked using current local information immediately before each movement.

2.4 Preparedness and approval process

Once we receive the team's details (Section 4) and the Terms of Reference, SOS Palestine reviews the request through the National Director and coordinates with Child Safeguarding, program management, HR, Operations, Logistics and Security to: confirm the mandate; complete visit-specific security and safeguarding assessments;

decide which locations and interviews can be facilitated; confirm route, arrival, accommodation, transport, drivers, routes and movement times; set medical, communications and check-in procedures; and deliver a pre-deployment or arrival briefing followed by daily reviews. A minimum lead time of 14 days applies under the SOS Global Travel Safety procedure, and longer for complex itineraries, multiple or sensitive locations, special permits, or any Gaza-related activity.

2.5 Personnel and access

Likely accessible, subject to final review: the National Office and SOS Children's Village in Bethlehem, selected program offices and community locations, approved youth locations, and selected Hebron locations after a specific assessment.

Restricted or likely inaccessible: Gaza (unless separately approved), areas of active operations or declared closed military zones, refugee camps during or immediately after operations, locations affected by active settler violence, anywhere under curfew or severe movement restrictions, and any residential site or interview where safeguarding approval, informed consent, or privacy cannot be assured.

Entry to the West Bank is controlled by the responsible authorities' immigration and security procedures. Separately, SOS internal authorization is required before any access to premises, residential sites, children, young people, families, staff, or case files.

2.6 Threat and incident history

The operating environment may include military operations and incursions, checkpoint and road-gate closures, occasional curfews, settler violence, demonstrations, ambulance and emergency delays, telecommunications and electricity interruptions, regional escalation and falling-debris hazards — together with the safeguarding and psychological strain such conditions place on children, families and staff. A restricted incident summary for the agreed period (recommended: the previous 6–12 months) will be provided, including the date, general location, category, a short factual description, impact, and action taken. Children's names, exact addresses, identifiable case details, staff personal information and detailed site vulnerabilities are removed from any external version.

2.7 Medical and emergency arrangements

For activities in Bethlehem, the main emergency resources are the Palestine Red Crescent ambulance service and Beit Jala Governmental Hospital, with the Bethlehem Arab Society for Rehabilitation and other facilities used as appropriate; for Hebron, the visit plan identifies the nearest suitable facility for the exact location. Response can be affected by closures, checkpoints, ambulance availability and hospital capacity, and serious cases may require transfer toward Jerusalem or Israel, which is checkpoint-dependent.

SOS Palestine can support first aid, ambulance coordination, local hospital transfer, emergency communication, and liaison with the team's employer and insurer. This

does not include international or cross-border medical evacuation, repatriation, insurance, or payment of medical costs. The team must hold its own insurance covering emergency treatment, medical evacuation, repatriation, trip disruption, and conflict-related incidents, where available, as well as specialist treatment outside the West Bank.

2.8 Communications

Palestinian mobile networks, mobile data, and office or hotel internet are generally available, with calls, SMS, Signal, WhatsApp, and Microsoft Teams in normal use; coverage can drop during operations, regional escalations, outages, or in weak-signal areas. The team should bring unlocked phones, power banks and chargers (including vehicle chargers) and keep offline copies of key contacts and documents. SOS can help with local SIM cards, including an emergency communication group, and scheduled check-ins with escalation if a check-in is missed. Satellite phones, radios or other regulated equipment should not be brought in or used without first confirming the authorization requirements.

2.9 In-country support

SOS Palestine has a designated West Bank Security Focal Point who coordinates directly with the team on arrival planning, briefings, daily route and movement reviews, check-ins, incident escalation, and decisions to suspend movement. Transport should be arranged through SOS Palestine or an approved provider, using vetted drivers and roadworthy, insured vehicles, with drivers who know local routes, checkpoints and alternates and who meet safeguarding and confidentiality requirements. Unapproved taxis or independent travel to program locations are not recommended.

2.10 Accommodation and movement

Accommodation recommendations will follow once team composition, route, schedule, and requirements are confirmed; suitable options are likely in Bethlehem, Beit Jala, or Beit Sahour. Each option is assessed against location and access routes, distance from programs and medical facilities, access and visitor control, fire safety, backup power, communications and safe areas, and classified as approved, provisionally acceptable, not yet assessed, or not recommended.

Field movement should be daylight-only, on an approved route with an alternate route, using an approved vehicle and driver, preceded by a security check and confirmed at departure and arrival, and suspended if conditions become unacceptable. The team should avoid demonstrations, points of confrontation, active operational areas, settlement and outpost approaches, refugee camps during incidents.

2.11 Contingency and evacuation

SOS Palestine maintains crisis-management procedures — shelter-in-place, lockdown, hibernation, movement suspension, temporary relocation, medical response, and escalation to the Crisis Management Team. While at an SOS location or

in an SOS-arranged vehicle, the team may be included in immediate local protective measures. This does not constitute international or medical evacuation, repatriation, insurance, or cross-border extraction, which remain the responsibility of the team's employer and insurer unless confirmed otherwise in writing. If conditions deteriorate, SOS may suspend activities, hold the team in place or relocate it, restrict movement, activate the Crisis Management Team, liaise with the team's employer, insurer and security provider, and assist movement toward an airport or crossing where safe. The National Director, with the Security Focal Point, may suspend any SOS-supported movement when the assessed risk becomes unacceptable.

2.12 Additional safeguarding and operational requirements

- **Child safeguarding:** all contact with children and young people follows SOS Child Safeguarding procedures; participation is voluntary, with appropriate informed consent and assent where applicable. Investigators should not contact children, families, caregivers or former participants independently — interviews are arranged through authorized focal people, and none proceeds where it may cause additional harm. Support is available before, during and after interviews.
- **Confidentiality and data protection:** personal and case information is shared only where necessary and only through approved secure channels and is not stored on unapproved personal devices or cloud platforms. Recording must be approved in advance, and interpreters and support staff sign confidentiality commitments.
- **Photography and recording:** require prior authorization. Do not photograph children, residential locations, security arrangements, checkpoints, military personnel, sensitive documents, or community members without consent.
- **Conduct and movement:** keep a low profile; no political activity or participation in demonstrations; follow approved routes and schedules; allow contingency time for checkpoints and delays; hold a morning security briefing and an end-of-day check-in; and report any security or safeguarding concern immediately.

3. Mandatory SOS Global Travel Safety requirements

Everyone travelling on behalf of SOS Children's Villages must comply with the Global Travel Safety procedures. In short: complete the Global Travel Safety Form at least 14 days before departure (available on the official Global Travel Safety SharePoint site); complete the UNDSS BSAFE security-awareness course before travel; and have travel plans reviewed by the relevant Security Focal Points and managers, including assessment of the destination security tier and the proposed itinerary, and any additional mitigation. Travel arrangements should not be finalised until these reviews and approvals are complete.

The travelling team should confirm: the Global Travel Safety Form has been submitted; UNDSS BSAFE is complete; travel is approved; medical, evacuation and repatriation insurance are in place; emergency contacts are provided; and the required mitigation measures are accepted.

4. Information we need from your team

To proceed with detailed planning, please provide: proposed arrival and departure dates; full names, nationalities, passport types and validity (and any dual nationality or residency); the preferred entry route; the Terms of Reference and the investigation's scope and objectives; the proposed program locations and the categories of people to be interviewed; a proposed daily schedule; interpretation, accessibility, mobility and relevant medical requirements; emergency contacts; travel, medical-evacuation and repatriation insurance details; the communications and electronic equipment to be carried; and confirmation that the Global Travel Safety Form has been submitted and UNDSS BSAFE completed.

Sources (general context)

SOS Children's Villages Palestine public program information; SOS Palestine internal security reporting and incident records (once confirmed); UN Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs; Israel Airports Authority information on the Allenby and Jordan River crossings; relevant government entry and travel information; SOS Global Travel Safety procedures; and UNDSS BSAFE. All public-source information is point-in-time and must be revalidated immediately before deployment.